



Wāndyr

an Adventure Game



Wåndyr, an Adventure Game

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About the Name: Wåndyr is “wander” as in travel about, but also “wonder” as in finding wondrous things in your travels, and maybe bringing them back.

Welcome to Wåndyr!

Wåndyr is an adventure game about a band of adventurers wandering through a pulp fantasy world. The focus is on exploration, following rumors, discovering places, treasure hunting, camping, singing, storytelling, cleverly overcoming impossible odds, naming weapons, and coming back alive with tales to tell. In the spirit of *The Hobbit*, Wåndyr celebrates the journey of going there and back again.



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Starting a Game

Get together with friends. One is the Guide, the others are players.

1 - Starting Location

The Guide describes the starting location for the adventure, such as a medieval tavern in a frontier town. The Guide can place this into a larger fantasy world, or let that be a mystery for now.

2 - Create Characters

Create three characters, each with 2 Traits and 2 Skills:

SYR TIRIEL: PIOUS, KNIGHT | POLEAX, ARMOR

LINDON: SHARP-EYED, SCOUT | LONGBOW, AX

HELIÖN: STRONG, HALE | MACE, SHIELD

MEMNETH: FIERY, ENERGETIC | ELEMENTALE, STAFF

BEL: FRIENDLY, BARD | CANTING, LUTE



3 - Muster a Character

Roll 2d6 Hearts for each of your three characters to see how they are feeling today, then choose one

to "Muster" (play). From now on, you play as your mustered character.

4 - Select a Rumor

The Guide lists three rumors that hint about troublesome events or mysterious places to explore. Choose one rumor to follow now. Also elect a Party Leader.

5 - Pack for the Journey

The Guide will provide you with a few "hand me down" items such as weapons, armor, spellbooks, etc. The Guide may also provide travel supplies (e.g. food, water, cloak).

6 - Embark

The Guide will narrate the start of your journey and provide a landmark or general directions so the path forward is clear. You play your mustered character; the Guide handles everything else.



Characters

Each character starts with an alias, two Traits and two Skills. The Traits are how you play the character, and the Skills are what the character knows how to do.

For example, "Rook: agile cunning | knife, (lockpicks)" goes by the alias "Rook", should be played as "agile and cunning", and knows how to use a knife and (secretly) lockpicks.

Traits

A Trait is a keyword that describes how your character is played. *This is perhaps more important than it sounds.* This is not about what your character knows or can do, but more about how they behave. For example, a character with the "bard" Trait *acts* like a musician or skald, while Skills determine what they know how to do. You can think of these as "soft skills" that complement their "hard" Skills.

Guidelines: Each Trait must be a single word, or common compound word (e.g. "rat-catcher", "horse-thief"). Traits can describe physical appearance, personality, quirks, habits, customs, approach to solving problems, etc. Traits can refer to a culture, homeland, or ancestry (human, elf, dwarf, etc.) or whatever helps you paint a picture.



Skills

A Skill is something the character has learned, either an item proficiency or a knowledge. Examples: dagger, longsword, bow, lockpicks, shield, armor, type of animal, spellbook, wand, arcane staff, harp, bushcraft, etc. You can think of these as "hard skills", or technical knowledge. Skills are not about personality or behavior, but about what the character knows how to do.

Guidelines: Each Skill must be a single word, or common compound word corresponding to a type of item or knowledge (e.g. "greatsword", "herbal medicine").

Specialized Skills: Using specialized items or knowledge requires a specialized or rare Skill, such as "greatsword", "herbal medicine", or a magic school.

Sample Traits (ð66)

1.1 AGILE	3.1 WEATHERED	5.1 FOCUSED
1.2 CALCULATING	3.2 OBSERVANT	5.2 ARTISTIC
1.3 SILENT	3.3 FERAL	5.3 PENSIVE
1.4 CHARMING	3.4 VIGILANT	5.4 RIGHTEOUS
1.5 NIMBLE	3.5 IMPETUOUS	5.5 AMBITIOUS
1.6 DEADLY	3.6 HALLOW	5.6 FIERY
2.1 FIERCE	4.1 LITHE	6.1 NOBLE
2.2 STRONG	4.2 STEADFAST	6.2 ENDURING
2.3 TOUGH	4.3 METICULOUS	6.3 DREAMY
2.4 GRIZZLED	4.4 STEELY	6.4 HARDY
2.5 ALERT	4.5 BRAVE	6.5 POWERFUL
2.6 HONORABLE	4.6 CUNNING	6.6 KEEN-EYED

Sample Skills (ð66)

1.1 ARMING SWORD	3.1 ROPE	5.1 DISGUISE
1.2 BATTLE AX	3.2 TRACKING	5.2 TRAPS
1.3 LONGBOW	3.3 FIRST AID	5.3 LOCKPICKS
1.4 SPEAR	3.4 COOKING	5.4 FORGERY
1.5 DAGGER	3.5 SWIMMING	5.5 POISONS
1.6 GREATSWORD	3.6 RIDING	5.6 CANTING
2.1 GAMBESON	4.1 GEOGRAPHY	6.1 ELEMENTALE
2.2 CHAINMAIL	4.2 HERALDRY	6.2 ILLUSIONE
2.3 PLATE ARMOR	4.3 HERBALISM	6.3 THAUMATURGY
2.4 SHIELD	4.4 HISTORY	6.4 NECROMANTIA
2.5 BUCKLER	4.5 MAGIC LORE	6.5 UMBRAKALA
2.6 HELMET	4.6 MONSTER LORE	6.6 VITAE

Example Characters

Choose or roll d66, or mix n' match parts. The format is **Alias: Traits | Skills**, with Songs in quotes.

1.1 Rook: agile cunning | knife, (lockpicks)

1.2 Cipher: calculating elusive | ciphers,
daggers

1.3 Shadow: silent (ruthless) | blowgun,
poisons

1.4 Wilde: charming strong | cards, cutlass

1.5 Lyra: nimble (spy) | rope, spy ciphers

1.6 Pearl: deadly noble | disguise kit,
(stiletto)

2.1 Serra: fierce shieldmaiden | battle ax,
shield

2.2 Magnus: strong, boisterous | warhammer,
armor

2.3 Iron: tough dwarf | axe, shield

2.4 Sarge: grizzled soldier | arming sword,
armor

2.5 Pike: alert guard | halberd, whistle

2.6 Shiro: honorable lethal | katana,
wakizashi

3.1 Drake: weathered wanderer | machete,
tinderbox

3.2 Slate: observant scout | telescope, bow

3.3 Wolf: (feral) hunter | spear, "Song of the
Wild"

3.4 Hawk: vigilant scout | longbow,
falconry-glove

3.5 Storm: impetuous, daring | javelin,
grapnel

3.6 Echo: hallow elf | harp | "Elven Ballad of
Hope"

4.1 Kat: lithe second-story-thief | (grappling
hook, thieves tools)

4.2 Forge: steadfast armorer | armor,
hammer

4.3 Quill: meticulous learned | ledger, inkwell

4.4 Flint: steely dwarf | axe, cookpot

4.5 Nails: tough soldier | flail, gambeson

4.6 Lindon: brave, strong | poleax, armor

5.1 Khael: focused witch-hunter |
umbrakala binding chains

5.2 Vesper: artistic scholar | ilusione staff

5.3 Twilight: pensive devious | umbrakala
sickle

5.4 Istar: honorable white-wizard | vitae
staff

5.5 Hezerek: ambitious (shady) | umbrakala
orb

5.6 Ignus: fiery driven | elementale staff

6.1 Dusk: honorable noble | ancestral blade,
doublet

6.2 Oak: strong enduring | staff, rope

6.3 Vale: woodcraft hunter | longbow, knife

6.4 Digs: dwarf prospector | pickaxe, mining
helmet

6.5 Bear: strong warrior | maul, bearskin
cloak

6.6 Thalia: keen-eyed elf | bow, sword

The Muster

Ok boys, check your kit, check your weapons, it's today. You get a pint and a chaser, no more. Let's go

Hearts

Roll 2d6 Hearts for each of your three characters to see how they feel today. Choose one character to Muster (play) today.

Equipment

You have **10 Item Slots** for readily equipped gear such as armor, weapons, light, and magic items. Most items use one slot; larger items use multiple slots. These are your "hot bar" of quickly-accessible items.

Baggage

If you have a bag (sack, rucksack, haversack, etc.) you can carry a few items beyond your 10 Item Slots. This counts as "Baggage", which limits movement and may prevent safely swimming, climbing, leaping, etc.

Dropping Baggage takes 1 Round (10 sec), and accessing items inside takes 1 Turn (10 min).

You also have "Baggage" if your hands are occupied with something not listed in your item slots.



Item Slot Examples

Small Items: coin pouch 1, water skin 1, lockpicks 1

Weapons: dagger 1, sword 2, longsword 3, greatsword 4, halberd 4, pike 5

Armor: gauntlets 1, helm 1, gambeson 2, coat of plates 3, full brigandine 4

Shields: buckler 1, heater 2, round shield 3, tower shield 4

Bows: arrow quiver 1, bow 2, crossbow 3, arbalest 4

Clothing: shirt 1, pants 1, boots 1, cloak 1, hat 1, ring 1, formal attire 2, cold gear 3

Light: torch 1, oil flask 1, lantern 1, tinderbox 1, firewood 3

Musical Instrument: voice 1, pipe 1, lute 2, guitar 3, drum 4

Hospitality: spice pouch 1, tea kettle 1, pipe & leaf 1, cookpot 2, wine & cups 2, mess kit 3, kitchen 4

Animals: cat 1, hawk 1, dog 2, war dog 3, horse 4

Rumors

The Guide should provide the players with three rumors to follow by rolling on the spark table below.

1.1 Caravan Overdue - expected last week **1.2** Heir Vanished - bed found empty **1.3** Widow Searching - husband's killer **1.4** Merchant Hoarding - grain stores locked **1.5** Captain Bribe - looks away nightly **1.6** Priest Preaching - doom approaches soon

2.1 Orcs Raiding - north road unsafe **2.2** Wolves Prowling - unnaturally bold **2.3** Bandits Active - masked and organized **2.4** Cultists Gathering - secret midnight rites **2.5** Smugglers Moving - caves below cliffs **2.6** Sellswords Hiring - no questions asked

3.1 Tomb Unsealed - stone pushed aside **3.2** Tower Dark - wizard not seen **3.3** Bridge Flooded - river rising fast **3.4** Mine Collapsed - workers trapped below **3.5** Well Fouled - water tastes wrong **3.6** Road Watched - eyes in trees

4.1 Bodies Found - bearing strange marks **4.2** Gold Appearing - source unknown **4.3** Tracks Fresh - leading into hills **4.4** Letter Intercepted - seal broken carelessly **4.5** Witness Hiding - knows too much **4.6** Symbol Carved - same mark everywhere

5.1 Guild Investigating - asking hard questions **5.2** Watch Patrolling - doubled since Monday **5.3** Temple Praying - candles lit constantly **5.4** Crown Summoning - riders sent forth **5.5** Thieves Silent - even they're scared **5.6** Militia Mustering - weapons distributed freely

6.1 Moon Blood-Red - three nights running **6.2** Dreams Shared - same nightmare spreading **6.3** Dead Restless - graves disturbed nightly **6.4** Lights Dancing - ruins glow strangely **6.5** Plague Spreading - coughing in streets **6.6** Prophecy Spoken - old seer

Tip: The entries are written so words can be reversed or substituted.

Rumor Updates

The Guide updates each rumor at Muster. If the characters did something then that is the update. Otherwise, roll and combine the new result with the prior result. If the characters complete a rumor then roll for a replacement so there are always three rumors.

- Session 1: "Well Fouled" + "Plague Spreading" (deadly?)
- Session 2: "Cultists Gathering" (are they responsible?)
- Session 3: Roll "Temple Praying" (do they take action?)

Locations

The Guide should provide the players with a few nearby locations by rolling on the spark table below.

1.1 Old Forest - trees whisper secrets **1.2** Misty Mountains - peaks lost in clouds **1.3** Barrow Downs - ancient burial mounds **1.4** Ruined Keep - moss covers old stone **1.5** Abandoned Mine - entrance gapes dark **1.6** Ancient Barrows - grass-covered mounds

2.1 Trading Post - wagons gather daily **2.2** Border Town - watchtowers loom close **2.3** Old Inn - smoke from chimney **2.4** Hilltop Village - surrounded by fields **2.5** Fishing Village - nets dry on posts **2.6** Crossroads Hamlet - where paths meet

3.1 Sacred Grove - ancient trees stand tall **3.2** Haunted Moor - mists never lift **3.3** Cursed Mire - water lies still and black **3.4** Holy Spring - water runs clear **3.5** Standing Stones - circle of monoliths **3.6** Old Mill - wheel creaks in wind

4.1 Mountain Pass - narrow and treacherous **4.2** River Ford - shallow crossing point **4.3** Ancient Road - stones worn smooth **4.4** Old Crossroads - weathered signpost **4.5** Hidden Valley -

ringed by peaks **4.6** Rocky Crag - jutting stone spires

5.1 Shadowy Glen - sunlight struggles through **5.2** Sunlit Meadow - flowers bloom wild **5.3** Foggy Marsh - ground sucks at boots **5.4** Windy Moor - heather sways constant **5.5** Quiet Dell - peaceful and sheltered **5.6** Echoing Canyon - sound carries far

6.1 Abandoned Watchtower - forgotten border post **6.2** Old Estate - manor house crumbling **6.3** Ancient Ruins - foundation stones remain **6.4** Desolate Wasteland - nothing grows here **6.5** Hidden Grotto - behind waterfall **6.6** Old Bridge - stone arches span river

Tip: The entries are written so words can be reversed or substituted.

Location Updates

The Guide can update a location upon visit; roll and combine the new result with the prior result. Roll new locations for rumors.

- Session 1: "Old Forest" + "Shadowy Glen" (what lies within?)
- Session 2: Roll "Sacred Grove" (is it hidden in the forest?)
- Session 3: Roll "Standing Stones" (ancient site discovered?)

Playing the Game

The game mostly consists of a conversation around the table. The Guide describes the world and people in it other than your characters.

You can have your character attempt anything you want. The Guide decides what happens, or consults the Oracle.

The Oracle

The Oracle answers any yes/no question. Roll 2d6: on 8 or higher the answer is "Yes", otherwise "No".

Easy/Hard: The Oracle number won't always be 8; the Guide will adjust it based on what you are attempting to do. The range is 6-12: easy (6), normal (8), hard (10), or extreme (12).

Sweet and Spicy

If any die rolls a 6 or a 1, add a twist! 6s are Sweet (good surprises) and 1s are Spicy (not-so-good surprises). Interpret the twist yourself, or ask the Oracle if uncertain.

Example: An archer snipes a sentry. On "sweet" the uniform is spotless; on "spicy" another guard notices.

Double Sweet/Spicy: When you roll double 6s or 1s in an important moment, the twist is extreme—ask the Oracle a question. On Double Sweet, ask something hopeful: "Does he drop his sword?" On Double Spicy, ask something dire: "Do I lose my footing?"

If your Double Sweet question is ambitious—a disarm, a mighty throw—use Attempting the Extraordinary. If you succeed with Sweet, you may learn it as a Knack (3 XP).



Who Asks?

Your character can try anything! When you say your character attempts a direct action, then you roll to ask the Oracle if it happens.

Otherwise, the Guide rolls, especially for unestablished facts:

Tip: Phrase the question from a character perspective, where they hope for "Yes". For example, "Do we find shelter?" is better than "Does the storm catch us?" so that a high roll (e.g. 5+6) results in "yes". Focusing on intention may be better than details.

Insight

Roll d6 once per Round and Turn:

1. TRAIT
2. SKILL
3. ITEM
4. BYNAME
5. FEAT
6. EFFORT

For each roll this Turn, if you match the criteria then roll with Advantage (3d6, drop lowest unless 1).

Trait: your approach matches a Trait

Skill: you use a helpful Skill

Item: you use a helpful item (special items need special Skills)

Byname: you use a helpful Byname

Feat: you have done this before in the game. This isn't your first time overcoming this foe or situation.

Effort: you push harder (not possible with Baggage, stealth,

climbing, swimming, wrestling, or when making it look easy)

Disadvantage

A Disadvantage may apply for various factors, such as being unarmed, encumbered, poor position/visibility, firing a bow into or out of melee, etc. If you have Disadvantage then roll 3d6 and drop the highest. *Advantage cancels Disadvantage.*

Deeper Questions

If you need more than yes/no, the Oracle can play "20 questions". The Guide should also use random tables from OSR or those in the **Wândyr World Oracle**.

Guide Tip: Ask an AI to generate a table, then proof it, and then have a player roll on it.

Area of Effect

If you and your companions are attacked by dragonbreath or some other area-of-effect attack, each of you will need to roll a defense.

If you attack your enemies with an area-of-effect attack, such as a *fireball* spell or rockslide, you will need to roll for *each* enemy (the Guide may group similar enemies).



Attempting the Extraordinary

When you attempt something beyond ordinary ability—a feat of heroism, a spell, an invocation—describe what you do. The Guide assigns a Level; you pay that Level in Hearts; then ask the Oracle if you succeed.

The maximum Level you can attempt is your relevant Alignment (e.g. magic school for spells, fighting style for knacks, the *being* for invocations, etc.). The Guide sets the Oracle target based on the situation—working at your maximum makes it harder.

Extraordinary Alignment: When stars align—a sacred site, divine favor, momentum from Double Sweet, or just to keep things moving—the Guide may temporarily improve your Alignment by +1.

Morale

Your character Hearts keep your character wandering, but morale keeps your party together.

Morale grants extra Hearts and opportunities to replenish them.

Leadership

When the leader's spirit holds, the company follows.

Party Leader: If you elect a character to lead your group, they are the “Party Leader.” They choose one of their Alignments at Muster and gain extra Hearts equal to that Level. The Leader can spend their own Hearts to absorb damage from companions—taking the blow meant for another, or rallying someone who falters. This cannot pay for spells or invocations.

Hospitality

Hospitality is important because it makes everywhere feel like home.

Sharing: You can share provisions to restore Hearts. The meal takes 1 hour and restores 1 Heart per character. This consumes 1 Provision (feeds up to 6). You can purchase Provisions in town (1 gp each) or hunt/forage in the wild.

Comforts: Comforts are finer provisions—cold chicken and pickles, seed-cakes, bacon and

eggs, a good cheese, pipe and leaf, or a proper tea. Buy +1 Comforts in town (10 gp each). Exquisite +2 Comforts are rare gifts: "Beorn's honey" or "elven waybread".

Host: If you keep Comforts or hospitality gear in Item Slots from Muster, you are a "host." You can offer refreshment as an Action; each character who partakes (everyone needs to spend an Action) regains 1 Heart. Total Hearts per Muster limited to Item Slots plus Recipes.



Music

Music is important because it makes everything better.

Performance: You can play music to restore Hearts once per Muster. The performance takes 1 hour and restores 1 Heart per character who participates (requires a music instrument and Skill). If you

combine a performance with a meal, the "host".

Bard: If you equip a musical instrument at Muster, you are a "bard". You can play (Action) to restore 1 Heart to whoever needs it most. Total Hearts per Muster limited to Item Slots plus Songs.

Animal Companions

A loyal hound, a clever raven, a pony who finds its way home—animals are companions on the road. An animal in an Item Slot from Muster can restore 1 Heart via their NPC Action (limit 1 / Muster). This represents the simple comfort of loyal company—a dog at your feet by the fire, a pony nuzzling your pocket for apples.

About Morale

In the spirit of The Hobbit, Wändyr celebrates the journey of going there and back again. What makes the journey meaningful? Not just the dragon at the end, but the longing for home along the way—and the companions who carry a piece of home with them into the wild.

The leader is the compass. The host reminds you of the table you'll sit at when you return. The bard reminds you of the songs you'll sing by your own fire. That's morale. That's what keeps the company together when the road grows dark.

Camp

The game starts with Muster and ends or pauses in Camp. When you decide to stop and rest, you must choose whether to make a temporary camp or return to a prior camp. The game is then paused until the next Muster.

Camp Followers

Anyone not in the Muster is assumed to follow along behind to set up the next camp and stay ready for the next Muster.

In Wândyr, we generally hand-wave camp setup and travel time between camps. You can usually fast-travel between your camps. You might also be able to leave larger items of treasure behind, flagged for pickup.

Home Base

At some point you may decide to establish a permanent camp or "home base", such as a cave, frontier tower, tavern, or hideout. This gives you a secure place to store loot. You can have multiple bases, making fast-travel even more useful.

Equipment

Wândyr assumes a traditional fantasy economy using gold pieces (gp), where quaint medieval items are available for sale in towns.

Equipment Price Guide

Common items cost 1gp per item slot. Examples: clothing, provisions, water skin, tools, etc.

Armaments cost 5gp per item slot. Examples: weapons, armor, shields, arrows.

Niche items cost 10gp per item slot. Examples: books, music instruments, lockpicks, comforts (+1 provisions), and unusual munitions.

Masterwork items are +1 and cost an extra 100gp. Add weapon plus to damage and armor plus to Iron Hearts. Grandmasterwork are +2, 1,000gp, and rare.

Elevated items cost an extra 10gp for "good", 100gp "rich", 1,000gp for "noble", and so on.

Magic items have a magical feature. Elven boots silence footsteps, a hero's belt bestows strength, and a magic shield is more protective. You can usually discover its enchantment through use, especially with Skill in the item. Magic items are rarely sold.

Experience

New characters are unproven, untested novices with no prior experience, or heroic deeds. All this must develop during the game.

You will earn 1-6 Experience Points (XP) after following your selected rumor to its full conclusion and returning to camp.

You can also earn small spot bonuses of 1 XP for deeds important in Wandyr: discovering an important new location or magical feature, mapping a new region, experimenting with magic, or rescuing captives. *Slaying monsters and looting treasure never directly earns XP.*

Spending XP

XP can be spent in camp to buy advancements. New Traits and Skills cost 3 XP each. The following advancements are available if you meet their requirements. Each advancement costs 3 XP.

Byname

Once an item has served you well in a significant deed, you can give it a Byname for 3 XP. For example, after narrowly slaying a horrid troll you might name your sword "Trollbane". An artisan can add decorations or inscriptions (inlays, etchings, jewels, gold leaf, gold pommel, etc.). Also possible for animal companions.

You might also be given a "byname" such as an honorable title, epithet, or honorific. Once you have led companions through danger, shouldered a burden others could not bear, or stood firm when all seemed lost, you may earn a byname. Bynames are usually assigned to you rather than chosen for yourself.

Songs and Recipes

A song is a piece of music that stays with you—the kind hummed on long roads or sung when the fire burns low, over supper with unexpected guests, beneath the mountains, or when dawn seems far away. A recipe is a dish that tastes like home, however far you've wandered—shared before a dark road, beside a stranger's fire, or when spirits need lifting more than bellies. Each costs 3 XP.

Spell

After you successfully cast a spell from a spellbook, with Sweet, you can "learn" that spell for 3 XP, and can cast it without the spellbook.

Arcana

You can transfer a *known spell* from a spellbook to an Arcana for 3 XP.

Arcana are "drippy wizard costume" items (wand, orb, staff, hat, robes, crystal, etc.) or another item with 1,000 gp of "magic-fashion bling".

The power words from the spell vanish from the book and appear on the item. The spellbook can no longer be used to cast that spell. *In theory this might be reversible.*

Relic

When you successfully make an Invocation to an otherworldly being, with Sweet, you can memorialize the connection in a Relic for 3 XP.

A Relic can be made from a humble object (a bone, a stone, a lock of hair, a feather) or another item with 1,000 gp of "holier-than-thou" adornment. An empty vessel is needed: magic items, Arcana, or existing Relics cannot be used.

Knack

A Knack is a signature move learned through Double Sweet (see The Oracle: Sweet and Spicy). Knacks cost 3 XP. Future use is limited by your Alignment—you may need extraordinary circumstances to repeat it.

Alignment

Alignment measures your level of connection to a specific concept—a magic school, combat style, faction, otherworldly being.

To find your Alignment, count all relevant Advancements and divide by 3, rounding down. Examples:

- "Honor" 1 (Traits "knight, honorable", Byname "Defender of the Realm")
- "Fighter" 2 (Traits "strong, tough, iron", Skills "sword, shield, armor, axe")

Game Flow

To add a sense of urgency, the Guide tracks 10-minute "Turns" using a "Turn Clock". This can be a glass or metal bowl on the table. The Guide loudly tosses a die into the clock each time you do something time-consuming. When the bowl is full with all six dice, an hour has passed; the Guide empties it and rolls the dice. Any 1's indicate a *spicy* complication such as a wandering monster. The Guide also rolls when you do something reckless, but puts the dice back in.

Combat Rounds

In combat, time is measured in 10-second "Rounds". This is just enough time for each character to move and take one action. The Turn Clock is usually paused in combat.

Mågic

Wåndyr is full of magic, and much of the game is about exploring and meddling with magical secrets.

All magic in Wåndyr involves *True Names*, either written or spoken as words of power.

Magic items and magical objects bear mystical inscriptions: sharp dwarven runes, flowing elven script, or shifting arcane glyphs, only decipherable by *magic-users*. If you have the correct magic school Skill you can read these words, else, they are just chicken scratch.



Magic-Users

If you have a Skill in a Magic School, you are a "magic-user" of that school. You are literate in the magic language and abstruse practices of that school.

Magic Schools

Magic is classified by "magic school". Words are magical, and magic is formed by magic words, runes, glyphs, arcane script, etc.

Each magic school is a Skill; the major schools are:

1. Vitae (Life)
2. Elementale (Elemental)
3. Thaumaturgy (Control)
4. Illusione (Illusion)
5. Umbrakala (Shadow Gates)
6. Necromantia (Death)
7. Canting (Thievery)

Each Magic School has its own list of spells and secret magic language, written, verbal, and somatic. Your Alignment to a magic school represents your understanding of its mysteries, and your "caster level".

Spell Casting

If you are a magic-user, you can use an Action to cast a spell. You must say the spell name and what you want the spell to do.

Saying what you want to do is especially important in Wåndyr since each spell consists solely of its name. You may not describe something inconsistent with the spell name or the general rules, but are otherwise free to try anything.

Prerequisites: Casting a spell requires a Spell written in a Spellbook. Most spellbooks have a single spell. You must say the magic words loudly and precisely. Once you have learned the spell (i.e. you are casting a “known spell”) you no longer need the book.

Spell Level: The Guide sets the Spell Level based on what you said you are trying to do. You must pay the Spell Level in Hearts to attempt the spell. *Use Arcana Hearts first.*

Roll for Control: Ask the Oracle if you controlled the spell. On YES: you did, but on NO: you did not.

The Guide sets the Oracle target number based on the situation. This does not usually involve the spell level or caster level.

Effects: The Guide will describe your spell effects (or may offer to let you do this yourself).

If you controlled the spell it should largely do what you wanted. If you did not control the spell, then something else happens, ranging from different effects, collateral

damage, or backlash damage to you. You can mitigate the risks by casting below your limit. Sweet/Spicy add a twist.

Caster Level

Your caster level is your level of Alignment with the magic school of the spell. This determines your level of magic literacy and the maximum spell level you can attempt. For example, if your Umbrakala level is 3 then you can attempt to cast Umbrakala spells of 3rd level or lower; you cannot even attempt a 4th level spell.

When casting a spell from a spellbook or Arcana, treat your caster level as 1 level higher.

Alignment

To find your Alignment, count all relevant Advancements (Traits, Skills, Names, etc.) and divide by 3, rounding down. For example, if you have an Umbrakala skill and know 6 Umbrakala spells, you are a 2nd level Umbrakala caster.

The Guide might ask for your Alignment to things other than magic schools or spells.

Learning Spells

Once you have cast a spell with Sweet, you are eligible to learn the spell. (See [Experience](#).) You no longer need a spellbook to cast a *known spell*, although it still helps.

Arcana

Arcana are "drippy wizard costume" items (wand, orb, staff, hat, robes, crystal, spell component pouch, etc.) or another item with 1,000 gp of "magic-fashion bling". To other people they appear like some kind of "wizard fashion statement".

Arcana Spells

Arcana can contain spells written in stylized words of power, and serve as spellbooks for casting those spells. (Similar to a spellbook, this grants a bonus of +1 to caster level.)

Arcana Hearts

If you are a magic-user and muster with Arcana, you gain 1 "Arcana Heart" per Arcana item, up to your Alignment across all Magic Schools. Requires a Skill in the Arcana item (e.g. wand, orb, etc). Arcana Hearts are used for casting spells and against hostile magic.



Arcana vs Magic Items

Arcana are magic items usable only by magic-users. The arts of creating magic items usable by anyone else are long lost, but they are not the same thing.

Vitae

Life force, growth, and harmony.
The magic of the Elves, written in living ink that grows and changes like vines. The hallow channel beneficial energies, promote growth, and keep nature's balance.

- 1.1** *Animal Bond* - form lasting connection
- 1.2** *Animal Friendship* - benevolent control
- 1.3** *Balance Weave* - unite opposites
- 1.4** *Beast Bond* - create long-lasting bond
- 1.5** *Beast Form* - friendly transformation
- 1.6** *Beast Speech* - talk with animals

- 2.1** *Divine Grace* - channel blessing
- 2.2** *Healing Touch* - cure wounds
- 2.3** *Joy Song* - lift spirits
- 2.4** *Life Bloom* - encourage growth
- 2.5** *Light Shield* - protect from evil
- 2.6** *Pacify* - remove violence

- 3.1** *Peace Aura* - calm violence
- 3.2** *Snail Knight* - summon noble mount
- 3.3** *Star Guide* - find true path
- 3.4** *Sun Beam* - channel daylight
- 3.5** *Thicket* - grow healthy plants
- 3.6** *Truth Sight* - see through lies

- 4.1** *Ward* - create protective barrier
- 4.2** *Cure Disease* - remove ailments
- 4.3** *Forest Touch* - speak with plants
- 4.4** *Growing Script* - living magical writing
- 4.5** *Nature's Blessing* - enhance

vitality

4.6 *Purification* - remove toxins

5.1 *Regeneration* - speed natural healing

5.2 *Heart Glyph* - inscribe emotions

5.3 *Nature's Bounty* - create food/water

5.4 *Pack Call* - summon animal allies

5.5 *Vital Surge* - boost life force

5.6 *Wild Empathy* - share animal feelings

6.1 *Life Transfer* - share vital force

6.2 *Nature's Rhythm* - align with cycles

6.3 *Perfect Unity* - complete balance

6.4 *Season's Call* - control growth cycle

6.5 *Tranquil Heart* - create inner peace

6.6 *Vital Harmony* - balance life forces

Elementale

Primal forces, elements, and weather. The Baal inscribe dragon magic in burning runes carved in stone. Practitioners control weather, create barriers of ice and fire, command gravity, and shape elements.

- 1.1** *Control Weather* - command climate
- 1.2** *Crystal Growth* - form gems
- 1.3** *Dragon's Breath* - channel flame
- 1.4** *Earth Shape* - mold stone
- 1.5** *Earthquake* - shake ground
- 1.6** *Element Master* - complete control

- 2.1** *Elemental Wall* - create barrier
- 2.2** *Fire Shield* - protective flames
- 2.3** *Fog Cloud* - create mist
- 2.4** *Force Wall* - energy barrier
- 2.5** *Gravity Shift* - change gravity
- 2.6** *Heat Metal* - make objects burning

- 3.1** *Icy Touch* - spread ice
- 3.2** *Increase Gravity* - triple weight
- 3.3** *Lightning Strike* - call electricity
- 3.4** *Liquid Air* - make air swimmable
- 3.5** *Mist Form* - become vapor
- 3.6** *Mountain's Strength* - earth power

- 4.1** *Rain Make* - create downpour
- 4.2** *Sculpt Elements* - shape materials
- 4.3** *Steam Form* - become vapor
- 4.4** *Stone Skin* - harden flesh

- 4.5** *Stone Tell* - read earth memories

- 4.6** *Storm Call* - summon thunder

- 5.1** *Summon Cube* - control earth

- 5.2** *Summon Idol* - create statue

- 5.3** *Thunder Call* - create sonic boom

- 5.4** *Tide Control* - command waters

- 5.5** *Upwell* - create spring

- 5.6** *Water Breathing* - breathe liquid

- 6.1** *Water Shape* - control liquid

- 6.2** *Web Weave* - spin natural nets

- 6.3** *Whirlwind* - create vortex

- 6.4** *Wind Shield* - air protection

- 6.5** *Wind Walk* - float on breeze

- 6.6** *Zephyr* - ride the winds

Thaumaturgy

Physical laws, mechanisms, and force. The engineering magic of the Dwur, written in foundational runes that command reality. Practitioners control objects, manipulate energy, bind powers, and impose their will upon matter.

- 1.1** *Adhere* - make sticky
- 1.2** *Animate Object* - objects obey
- 1.3** *Astral Prison* - crystal stasis
- 1.4** *Command* - force obedience
- 1.5** *Elasticity* - control form
- 1.6** *Filch* - teleport items

- 2.1** *Force Push* - directional power
- 2.2** *Haste* - control speed
- 2.3** *Hover* - control levitation
- 2.4** *Invisible Tether* - bind objects
- 2.5** *Knock* - open locks
- 2.6** *Leap* - control jumping

- 3.1** *Lock* - seal door
- 3.2** *Magic Suppressor* - null magic
- 3.3** *Masterscript* - write command runes
- 3.4** *Shrink Item* - reduce size
- 3.5** *Sort* - organize items
- 3.6** *Spider Climb* - control climbing

- 4.1** *Strengthen* - reinforce material
- 4.2** *Teleport* - move objects
- 4.3** *Time Slip* - control time
- 4.4** *Unravel* - counter spells
- 4.5** *Augment Object* - enhance item
- 4.6** *Control Device* - command mechanisms

- 5.1** *Animate Tool* - give purpose
- 5.2** *Binding Circle* - contain force
- 5.3** *Density Control* - alter mass
- 5.4** *Enhance Power* - boost magic
- 5.5** *Mend* - repair objects
- 5.6** *Object Memory* - read item history

- 6.1** *Reality Anchor* - stabilize space
- 6.2** *Rune Lock* - seal with power
- 6.3** *Shape Material* - change form
- 6.4** *Magic Circle* - create workspace
- 6.5** *Thaumaturgic Seal* - master rune
- 6.6** *Perfect Control* - complete mastery

Illusione

Perception, thought, and dreams.
The subtle magic of the Belerions,
woven from phantasmal scripts that
deceive the senses. Illusionists
create illusions, alter memories,
influence minds, and bend
perceived reality.

- 1.1** *Arcane Eye* - flying sensor
- 1.2** *Auditory Illusion* - create sounds
- 1.3** *Bewitch* - enchant mind
- 1.4** *Blur* - distort appearance
- 1.5** *Charm* - create friendship
- 1.6** *Detect Magic* - see magic

- 2.1** *Disguise* - alter appearance
- 2.2** *Dream Message* - send sleeping visions
- 2.3** *Dream Walking* - enter dreams
- 2.4** *Duplicate* - create copies
- 2.5** *Emotional Aura* - project feeling
- 2.6** *False Memory* - plant fake memory

- 3.1** *Feign Death* - appear dead
- 3.2** *Greed* - create obsession
- 3.3** *Hypnotize* - question trance
- 3.4** *Illusory Spray* - disorient with light
- 3.5** *Invisibility* - become unseen
- 3.6** *Mass Suggestion* - group command

- 4.1** *Major Image* - perfect illusion
- 4.2** *Mind Maze* - trap thoughts
- 4.3** *Mind Shield* - protect thoughts
- 4.4** *Mirror Image* - create duplicates
- 4.5** *Mirror Walk* - step through glass

- 4.6** *Perfect Illusion* - undetectable fake

- 5.1** *Phantom Sound* - distant noise

- 5.2** *Phantasmal Force* - moving illusion

- 5.3** *Programmed Illusion* - triggered effect

- 5.4** *Read Mind* - hear thoughts

- 5.5** *Scry* - share vision

- 5.6** *Silent Image* - create scene

- 6.1** *Spectacle* - create grand illusion

- 6.2** *Telepathy* - project thoughts

- 6.3** *True Seeing* - pierce deception

- 6.4** *Vision* - personal illusion

- 6.5** *Visual Illusion* - static images

- 6.6** *X-Ray Vision* - see through matter

Umbrakala

Shadows, thresholds, and dimensional paths. The secret magic of the Alu, written in darkness and void. Practitioners create Kalla gates, walk between shadows, craft dimensional spaces, and traverse the boundaries between realms.

- 1.1** *Befuddle* - shadow memories
- 1.2** *Body Swap* - shadow exchange
- 1.3** *Cloak of Shadows* - dark protection
- 1.4** *Dark Anchor* - fix dimensional point
- 1.5** *Darksight* - see in darkness
- 1.6** *Deep Shadow* - create pure darkness

- 2.1** *Dimension Door* - create portal
- 2.2** *Disassemble* - shadow-split form
- 2.3** *Gate Sense* - detect portals
- 2.4** *Hatred* - dark emotion
- 2.5** *Ice Heart* - freeze with shadow
- 2.6** *Kalla Gate* - create pocket realm

- 3.1** *Kallascript* - write gate runes
- 3.2** *Masquerade* - shadow dance
- 3.3** *Miniaturize* - shrink into shadows
- 3.4** *Mind Shatter* - shadow thoughts
- 3.5** *Night Sphere* - create darkness
- 3.6** *Nightmare Seed* - dark dreams

- 4.1** *Ooze Form* - shadow substance
- 4.2** *Phantom Coach* - shadow transport
- 4.3** *Plane Shift* - change reality
- 4.4** *Realm Weave* - connect spaces

4.5 *Shadow Bind* - trap in darkness

4.6 *Shadow Clone* - create dark duplicate

5.1 *Shadow Meld* - merge with darkness

5.2 *Shadow Step* - travel through dark

5.3 *Shadow Time* - pause in darkness

5.4 *Shuffle* - shadow displacement

5.5 *Smoke Form* - become shadow

5.6 *Space Fold* - bend dimensions

6.1 *Threshold Walk* - pass through doors

6.2 *Twilight Veil* - walk between worlds

6.3 *Void Gate* - open dark portal

6.4 *Void Shield* - dark protection

6.5 *Void Step* - brief teleport

6.6 *Perfect Shadow* - complete control

Necromantia

Death, spirits, and decay. The forbidden magic of the Avathars, inscribed in blood and bone. Practitioners bind spirits, animate dead, drain life force, and manipulate the boundary between life and death.

- 1.1** *Animate Skeleton* - raise bones
- 1.2** *Black Sacrament* - death ritual
- 1.3** *Blood Curse* - sacrifice life
- 1.4** *Blood Track* - follow wounds
- 1.5** *Bone Puppet* - animate dead
- 1.6** *Bone Shield* - skeletal armor

- 2.1** *Command Undead* - control dead
- 2.2** *Comprehend Dead* - dead languages
- 2.3** *Corpse Explosion* - detonate dead
- 2.4** *Dark Blessing* - death's power
- 2.5** *Death Gate* - portal to underworld
- 2.6** *Death Touch* - wither life

- 3.1** *Death Ward* - protect from necrotic
- 3.2** *Doom Mark* - mark for death
- 3.3** *Drain Life* - steal vitality
- 3.4** *Fear Aura* - death terror
- 3.5** *Ghost Bind* - trap spirits
- 3.6** *Grave Mist* - create death fog

- 4.1** *Life Sense* - detect living
- 4.2** *Mass Animation* - raise army
- 4.3** *Marble Madness* - death's toys
- 4.4** *Pain Echo* - share suffering
- 4.5** *Plague Wind* - spread death

4.6 *Psychometry* - read death echoes

- 5.1** *Raise Dead* - create undead
- 5.2** *Sniff* - smell death
- 5.3** *Soul Cage* - trap essence
- 5.4** *Soul Rend* - tear spirit
- 5.5** *Speak with Dead* - question spirits
- 5.6** *Spirit Chains* - bind ghost

- 6.1** *Spirit Form* - become ghostly
- 6.2** *Truth Sense* - death's truth
- 6.3** *Undead Sight* - see spirits
- 6.4** *Vampiric Touch* - drain energy
- 6.5** *Wizard Mark* - death runes
- 6.6** *Perfect Death* - ultimate end

Canting

The art of deception and manipulation. Spoken in Thieves' Cant, the secret language of thieves, written in flash papers and brotherhood marks. If you can't flash the patter, best stay out of the Darkmans.

- 1.1** *Mark the Gull* - spot easy marks
- 1.2** *Cony-Catch* - sense fears/vices
- 1.3** *Budge* - distance unlock
- 1.4** *Juke* - dodge attack
- 1.5** *Mort's Mask* - change face
- 1.6** *Flash Paper* - hidden messages

- 2.1** *Foist* - pickpocket from afar
- 2.2** *Nip* - summon loose object
- 2.3** *Second-Story Man* - sure climb
- 2.4** *Fleet Pad* - quickened step
- 2.5** *Darkmans Cloak* - shadow invisibility
- 2.6** *Spring* - enhanced leap

- 3.1** *Upright Man's Word* - command street folk
- 3.2** *Brotherhood Mark* - sense guild members
- 3.3** *Budge Barrel* - conceal goods
- 3.4** *Rum Dubber* - master lockpick
- 3.5** *Rearward Glim* - spot followers
- 3.6** *Dog's Leg* - tail undetected

- 4.1** *Maze Whispers* - distant eavesdrop
- 4.2** *Perfect Mort* - full impersonation
- 4.3** *Ken Miller* - break into any building
- 4.4** *Mizzle* - vanish when spotted
- 4.5** *Topping Cove* - cross rooftops
- 4.6** *Sharper's Nose* - sniff out weakness

- 5.1** *Rum Mort* - false identity
- 5.2** *Blood Brotherhood* - compel loyalty for job
- 5.3** *Mill the Watch* - silence sentry
- 5.4** *Rum Ken* - find safehouse
- 5.5** *Darkmans Veil* - unseen in crowds
- 5.6** *Many Faces* - shift personas

- 6.1** *Dimber Damber's Web* - silent signals
- 6.2** *Bulk the Watch* - distract guards
- 6.3** *Deathless Brotherhood* - speak with dead thieves
- 6.4** *Darkmans Twin* - shadow twin
- 6.5** *Jarkman's Gift* - living forgeries
- 6.6** *Prince of Thieves* - inspire loyalty

Invocations

You can make an Invocation to an *otherworldly being* by loudly and formally calling their True Name *thrice* and making a request.

Lore

Look for True Names in mythic places, written on runestones, tombs, or magic amulets. Randomly generate each name; *beings have many names*. You might want to ask the Oracle “have I heard this name before?”, “are they aligned with Law?”, etc. All this adds to the known Lore of the being.

Each being has a secret random table of Traits reflecting their nature—kept by the Guide and revealed only through Invocations.

Making an Invocation

Call the True Name *thrice* and state your request. You lose d6 Hearts. Next, ask the Oracle if the being responds. On Sweet they *like* the request, on Spicy they *dislike* it.

An Answer?

The Guide determines what happens next, following existing Lore, your Alignment with the being, context, and asking the Oracle various questions. The Guide sets an equivalent spell level for the effect up to the Hearts lost, and can limit Hearts lost for simple requests.

The workings of otherworldly beings are often mysterious. They may interpret your request from a different perspective and sense of time.



TWO BRIGHT FORMS MET HIM

Shaping Spirits

Making an Invocation changes your character, aligning and molding you into the shape of their ideal “Saint”. The Guide rolls on a secret Trait table for the being. If you already have the Trait, you are in harmony—no cost. Otherwise, you must buy that Trait for 3 XP.

Each being has their own nature. One might shape you toward “wrathful” or “storm-touched”; another might prefer “patient” or “sea-longing”.

Relics

A Relic is a sacred object that serves as conduit and ark—a rallying flag—to an otherworldly being. To the uninitiated, they may appear to be “cursed” or Sentient Items, as the being can use any powers of the item.

Ark: The Relic gives a +1 Alignment bonus for its Invocation.

Saint: If you Muster with a Relic of a being you are Aligned to, you are their “saint”. You may *bless* companions to zealously pursue a rumor the being likes. Each who accepts the blessing gains extra Hearts (lower of your Alignment and Relics in Item Slots). On failure to complete the rumor, even in death, the being may claim and *shape their spirits*.

Sentient Items

Sentient items contain a bound soul of a magic-user, elemental, *d’jinn*, *ifr’it*, *kha’din*, dragon, eldar, deep one, or other entity. Bound spirits are notoriously capricious, jealous, and unhinged from confinement, their original dreams and ambitions maybe twisted by madness.

Sentient items almost always have magic powers. Some powers might be similar to normal magic items. Others might only reveal themselves with attunement.

Sentient items are temperamental; when you first attempt to use one, ask the Oracle if the item “accepts” you. On Sweet or Spicy, the item also talks to you!

If you carry a sentient item, your character grows in *Alignment* and may discover deeper mysteries. You should take Traits that reflect this growing attachment. For example, you might take a Trait such as “Wielder of Duskbringer”. It’s petty, but they *hate* anyone who offends their fragile egos, such as carrying them after being rejected, refusing to follow their agenda, abandoning, or “cheating” on them with a rival item.



Fighting

In each Round, you can Move and Attack (or take another action).

Initiative

The Guide determines the order in which players and foes take their actions. You are likely to be called on earlier if you are on the front line.

Move

You can stand up OR move 40 feet (20 feet with Baggage). Each impediment (e.g. readying weapons, bad terrain, darkness) cuts this in half.

Attack

Ask the Oracle if you "hit"; this deals d6 Hearts. More lethal weapons may have a damage bonus, e.g. "greatsword +1".

Defend

When you are attacked or otherwise endangered, ask the Oracle if you avoid getting "hit". If you are hit, the Guide rolls Hearts lost (often d6).

Reduce melee damage by 1 Heart if you melee attack or parry that foe this round.

Armor and shields give 1 "iron" Heart per item slot, usable only against weapons. More protective

items may have a bonus, such as "shield +1".

At the Same Time

If you are targeted by an action (such as an attack or spell), you may take your action at the same time. Both actions resolve together unless one has "right of way".

The Guide decides "right of way". In general, weapon attacks have "right of way" over everything else. Melee has right-of-way over missiles. The need to move can be used as a tie breaker. When approaching from a distance the weapon with the better reach (by item slots) has "right of way". In close quarters combat (under 10 feet of space per person) the smaller weapon has "right of way".



Monsters

Each monster (or trap, etc.) has a **Level** comparable to **Alignment Level**. The Guide sets the Oracle to "hard" if this is higher than Alignment Level; or "easy" if lower. Consider using the party leader's level when working together.

- Lvl 0:** giant rat, vermin, goblin
- Lvl 1:** orc, skeleton, deathskito
- Lvl 2:** zombie, ghoul, big bug, slime
- Lvl 3:** wight, harpy, giant spider
- Lvl 4:** werewolf, ogre, huge slime
- Lvl 5:** mummy, minotaur, owlbeast
- Lvl 6:** troll, wyvern, manticores
- Lvl 7:** griffon, djinni, vampire
- Lvl 8:** hill giant, hydra
- Lvl 9:** chimera, stone giant
- Lvl 10:** golem, dragon

For more detail, the Guide can use OSR monsters or wing it as follows. **Pack/tribal monsters** have d6 Hearts and deal d6 damage per hit; leaders are tougher.

A solitary "apex predator" monster has 2d6 or 3d6 Hearts per Level, multiple attacks, plus a deadly attack of 2d6 or 3d6, or d6 Hearts per Round for Level Turns (for paralysis, poison, petrification, etc).



Death

Characters and monsters die at 0 Hearts. If you reach 0 Hearts, choose whether you die "offscreen" or "onscreen".

Offscreen: We cut away as your character drops; bring in another character next round. Offscreen deaths are uncertain. At any future Muster, you may let the character pass on, or let them make an Invocation to return. On **Double Spicy** (double 1s) they are dead with no uncertainty.

Onscreen: Describe one final heroic action on the next round; ask the Oracle if the action succeeds and then go Offscreen. *Heroic feats require Sweet. Spicy indicates immediate, final death*

Welcome to Wāndyr!

Wāndyr is an adventure game about a band of adventurers wandering through a pulp fantasy world. The focus is on exploration, following rumors, discovering places, treasure hunting, camping, singing, storytelling, cleverly overcoming impossible odds, naming weapons, and coming back alive with tales to tell. In the spirit of *The Hobbit*, Wāndyr celebrates the journey of going there and back again.

Sandbox Play

The Guide describes the world and serves to answer your questions. The Guide consults existing "lore" (their memory/notes about established facts) and the Oracle for anything else.

The local area remains wide open and undefined, even if some aspects of the wider world are known (or even part of a well-defined setting). This "sandbox" or "emergent play" style allows everyone at the table to discover the unexpected together. The Guide is also a player!

The Guide does not prepare a predefined story beforehand. Instead, the Guide uses dice and random tables to determine what happens. Each new discovery is a surprise to everyone and adds to

the growing lore of your world as you wander together.



The Oracle

The Oracle answers any yes/no question. Roll 2d6: on 8 or higher the answer is "Yes", otherwise "No".

The Guide will set the number lower if easy, higher if hard.

Roll with Advantage (roll 3 dice, drop lowest unless 1) if you can match the current **Insight**:

1. TRAIT
2. SKILL
3. ITEM
4. BYNAME
5. FEAT
6. EFFORT